

We'll shortly consider some ways of responding to Edwards' argument. But first let's think about how Edwards' argument might be related to an argument for fatalism.

Suppose that someone did not believe in God — and hence rejected premise (2) of Edwards' argument — but did believe that there were truths about all of our future actions. Could they give an argument similar to Edwards' argument?

There are truths
about our future
actions.

We have no
choice about the
past.

If we have no choice
about A, and no
choice about the
connection between
A and B, then we
have no choice about
B.

In the past, God
had
foreknowledge of
our future
actions.

To get a grip on this, imagine that one learned of another universe, which had its own system of time and space. And suppose one was given all of the information about everything that ever happens in that universe, and the time at which it happens. So, in particular, you know everything about every free action in that universe. But it's not like you knew of every action **before** that action occurred — you don't exist in the time of that universe.

Does the claim that God exists outside of time give us
reason to reject premise (2) of the foreknowledge
argument?

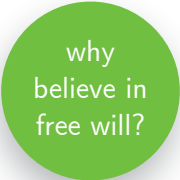
Let's look again at the premises which make
reference to time.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

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never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

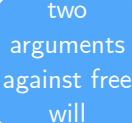
and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

things as fate, then there is no free will.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?



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replace reference to God's foreknowledge

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

with reference to the being of truth about

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.



perform a certain action (1,2)

5* We have noticed that the fact

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

1. We have no direct facts.

0 We have achieved what we

will perform various actions.

some action, then I will prefer that

(3, 4, 5)

3 We have not the fact that

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

acaiiOId.

all of our activities.

2* In the past, there were truths about

that if it is true that I will perform

then we have the choice about q.



God knows that in the future I will

The fatalist argument

freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

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